Chapter 24

O sinivi potee – The imported canoe called *potee*

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Figure 1: *O potee* – The imported canoe

(1)	*O sinivi potee*	The *potee* canoe
(2)	*O potee o meho kaku sinivi to tei nana Teapu.*	The *potee* is another type of canoe in the Teop area.
(3)	*Enaa kahi vahutate nom, havee to pakupaku vaavaha me raara e.*	I am going to tell you how we make it.
(4)	*Beara rake tea paku o potee, eara toro tagihu roho rasuu tea tara rakerake to naono vai to mataa nana tea paku bono potee.*	When we want to make a *potee*, we must first go into the jungle to look for a tree that is good for making the *potee*.

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(5)	*A kiu no potee sa beera potee haana bona kiu vaa teo sinivi suuna,*	The work of carving the *potee* is not as big as the work on the indigenous canoe,
(6)	*ei mea peha aba na antee nana tea paku bona.*	that is, a single person can do it.
(7)	*Me bea peha aba rova koa vurahe to naono, eove repaa tagava gunaha bona.*	And even when just a single person finds a (suitable) tree, he fells it.[1]
(8)	*Be tagava bona, eove repaa rom kurus bono govuhu no naono, be tara voen na mataa nana.*	When he has felled it, he cuts the crown of the tree off, if he sees that (the log) is good.
(9)	*Beve rom kurusu vakavara bona, eove repaa poana pete bona.*	When he has cut it off, he slices the upper side off the log.
(10)	*A kiu vaa teo potee a varuruva koa tabae o koma beera.*	The work on the potee canoe is easy, because it has a big inside.
(11)	*Be poana vakavara bona, eove repaa koro bona bona toraaraa ae a rom.*	When having sliced off its upper part, he carves the inside with an axe and a hoe.
(12)	*A kiu vaa tea koro koma sinivi a beera,*	The work of carving the inside of the indigenous canoe is big,
(13)	*me be nagunagu, eove repaa kaokahi bona ore paa vaavuriha.*	and when he gets exhausted, he leaves it to have a rest.
(14)	*A koro no komano sinivi potee na varuruva koana, sa potee haana bono komano sinivi suuna,*	The carving of the inside of the *potee* canoe is quite easy, it is not like the inside of the indigenous canoe,
(15)	*tabae na antee koa vonaen ei bean parata o buo kubisi, o kubis beera ae o kubis bebeahu.*	because (the indigenous canoe) is only as wide as the span between your thumb and your middle finger.[2]
(16)	*Bean boha voen paa anteu, ean repaa nao vo teo hum vaa tea pisipisi.*	When you think that it is enough, then you go on with the part of carving the pointed ends.
(17)	*Bean taraha pisi vakavara a peha papana, ean repaa nao pete vo tea meha papana.*	When you have finished planing one side of the pointed end, then you go on with the other side.

[1] Compare Chapter 7:5ff.

[2] lit. '... because only reaches like this: this (is) when you open the two fingers, the big finger and the long finger.'

(18)	*Be kavara, ean repaa koro vahabana o komano sinivi.*	After that, you carve again the inside of the canoe.
(19)	*Koro, koro, bean boha voen, "antee vai," ean repaa nao pete teo hum vaa tea govagovara o sinivi.*	Carve, carve, (and) when you think, "Enough now," you go on with the part of carving the bow and the stern of the canoe.
(20)	*Bean mei nom tea govara o sinivi, ean toro verete roho ei.*	Before you carve the bow and the stern of the canoe, you must turn it over.
(21)	*A kiu bona a beera,*	This work is big,
(22)	*meo aba o sii bero vareko toro paku bari.*	and more than one person must do it.
(23)	*Beam verete vakavara e, ean repaa taneo a kiu vaa tea govagovara.*	When you have turned it over, you start the work of carving the bow and the stern.
(24)	*Govara kaakoo teo ihu no sinivi,*	Carve by moving towards the nose of the canoe,
(25)	*ean repaa vaatotobin e,*	you make it straight,
(26)	*ean repaa govara pete o hum vaa teo itao.*	then you continue carving the part at the stern.
(27)	*Bea govara bona kavara, ean paa vaatotobin e.*	When this carving of stern and bow is finished, you make it straight.
(28)	*Be kavara, ean repaa verete vahae.*	When it is finished, you turn it over again.
(29)	*O sinivi paa aeae vaevuru,*	The canoe is already light now,
(30)	*me ean koa a peha na antee nom tea verete vahae.*	and you can turn it over again just by yourself.
(31)	*Bean verete vakavara, ean repaa koro vahabana e.*	When you have turned it over, you do some more carving on the inside.
(32)	*Koro, koro, bean boha voen paa anteu, ean paa antee,*	Carve (and) carve, (and) when you think that it is enough, you stop,
(33)	*ei ihuana vai o hum vaa tea rahi voosu.*	now (you) wait for the part of pulling (the canoe) home.
(34)	*Teo bon rahi no potee, ean repaa sue ki to sii aba ore ausu vuan tea rahi voosu e.*	For the day of pulling the potee canoe, you tell some people to assist you to pull it home.
(35)	*A kiu vai ahiki ta von,*	This work does not cost anything,

(36) *evehee ean toro paku a sii tabaan to kahi ma an koa vue o manae to paa nao nau tea rahi sinivi.*
but you should make some food that the young men will eat who have gone there to pull the canoe.

(37) *Beori rahi voosu maa bari, ean repaa vaan riori, a menaga, nahu iana bara ta maa meha tabaan bata mee.*
When they have pulled it home, you will give them to eat manioc dumplings, a pot of fish, and also some other food along with it.

(38) *Bea maa taba vai kavara, ean paa paku papahiana komana nom amaa sii vagegeana kiu.*
When these things are finished, you will do the final little pieces of work just by yourself.

(39) *Beo naono tei me nana bona maa panapanaa, ean repaa gono maa ta maa vua asita tea asita o sinivi tean.*
When the wood has knotholes, you get some putty nuts to seal your canoe with putty nut glue.



(a) (b) (c)

Figure 2: (a) *Asita* – Putty nut tree, (b) and (c) *Vua asita* – Putty nut

(40) *A meha maa naono na hiki ni nana bona panapanaa.*
Some trees do not have any knotholes.

(41) *Eikou ean repaa pahin paku bata koa amaa tapara.*
And so you straightaway make some *tapara* poles (that prevent the sides from moving inside).

(42) *O naono vai to tei me nana bona panapanaa toro vaatei roho beo asita raka roho nana.*
The wood that has knotholes must be left untouched until the glue has dried up.

(43) *Bean paku vakavara amaa tapara, ean repaa nao vo teo hum vaa tea pam no sinivi.*

When you have finished fixing the *tapara* poles, you move on to the part of tying up the canoe.



Figure 3: *Tapara* – Fixing poles inside the canoe

(44) *Teo potee, o buaku koa o vanai, o peho matana, o meho he itao.*

As for the *potee* canoe, there are only two outrigger booms, one near the bow, and the other near the stern.

(45) *Bean pam vakavara nio buo vanai, ean repaa tapa ae pam vagegeana koa nio aga ore paa kavara.*

When you have tied the two outrigger booms (to the hull of the canoe), you finally fix the float with pegs and lashings, and then it is finished.

(46) *Ei ean antee vai e tea hae tea vagana ge havee.*

Now you can board it to go fishing or whatever.

(47) *O kaku sinivi vai o sinivi vaa Solomon.*

This type of canoe is a canoe from the Solomon Islands.

(48) *Evehee a ta Solomon saka vaatei haari bono aga.*

But the Solomon people do not attach a float.

(49)	*Eve he nomaa voen meara paa vaatei o aga,*	When it came to us like this, we attached the float,
(50)	*ei kou a tahii teara na pohapoha sana nana.*	because our sea is very rough.
(51)	*O potee na antee nana tea tatana bona too hata.*	The *potee* can resist bad weather.
(52)	*Sa manin goo haana,*	It never sinks,
(53)	*o sinivi suuna he na antee nana tea goo.*	whereas the indigenous canoe can sink.



Figure 4: *Sima Rigamu na hua nana bono potee* –
Sima Rigamu is paddling a *potee*